

Product Spec: Self-Service Card Controls

Meridian Commercial Bank - Internal Document

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Overview

Self-Service Card Controls let customers lock/unlock their debit or credit card instantly from the mobile app, and set merchant-category or geographic spending restrictions, without contacting support.

Goals

- Reduce fraud-related support call volume by letting customers self-serve common actions (lost card, suspected fraud, travel).
- Give customers proactive control to prevent unwanted spending categories (e.g., gambling, online purchases) for themselves or authorized users on the account.

Requirements

1. Instant lock/unlock: toggling the lock in the app applies within 2 seconds by writing directly to the Card Authorization Service's card status field; CAS checks this status on every authorization request.
2. Merchant-category blocking: customers can toggle categories (e.g., gambling, online purchases, international transactions) on or off; blocked categories are declined at authorization time with a customer-facing reason code.
3. Geographic restriction: customers can restrict card usage to their home country; travel notifications temporarily lift this restriction for a customer-specified date range.
4. All control changes are logged and available in an audit view within the app for the customer's own reference.
5. Fraud Operations can also apply a lock on the customer's behalf (see RB-card-fraud-alert-triage); customer-initiated unlock does not override a fraud-initiated lock without a step-up verification flow.

Dependencies

- Card Authorization Service (ARCH-payments-platform-overview) for the real-time status/category check on every authorization.
- ARCH-identity-access-management for the step-up verification flow used when unlocking a fraud-initiated hold.

Non-Goals

- Per-transaction manual approval (customer approves each transaction individually) is out of scope; considered for a future "Card Controls Pro" tier.